

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 9 7
 ♥ 4 2
 ♦ K 10 8 4
 ♣ 9 6 5

♠ Q
 ♥ Q 10 9 7 6
 ♦ A J 3
 ♣ A 7 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 4
 ♥ 8 3
 ♦ Q 9 7 2
 ♣ K Q J 10

♠ 8 6 5 3 2
 ♥ A K J 5
 ♦ 6 5
 ♣ 8 3

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North

Ruff another ♠ with your second-last trump, then play ♦ A and concede a ♦.

Whichever minor suit the defense plays next you ruff in dummy, then ruff the fourth ♠, establishing dummy's ♠8 while you still have a trump left in dummy. Dummy is now high.

It took a 2-2 trump split and a 4-3 ♠ split. But that was your best shot.

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 6

Obviously you don't really have 6 losers since some of those ♦s and ♣s can be ruffed in dummy. But if you are playing against competent defenders you will only be able to ruff two of them because every time they get the lead they will play a trump. So you must figure on ruffing 2 losers and establishing dummy's fifth ♠ for a discard of the other one.

Win the ♣A and immediately play your ♠Q. The defense will win this trick and probably play a trump. Be sure to win this in dummy and then ruff a ♠ with a high ♥. Now exit with a ♣. They will win and probably play another trump. Win this one in dummy also, breathing a sigh of relief when ♥s split 2-2.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 6 3
 ♥ J 2
 ♦ Q J 10 7 6
 ♣ 8 4

♠ 8 7 5
 ♥ K 8 7 5 3
 ♦ A K 5
 ♣ 10 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 4
 ♥ Q 10 9 6
 ♦ 9 3 2
 ♣ 7 6 3

♠ A K 2
 ♥ A 4
 ♦ 8 4
 ♣ A K Q J 9 5

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♣
Pass	3NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♥	Pass	7♣
All Pass			

7♣ by South

The suit is now established, so you pull trumps, enter dummy one last time with the ♦K and discard that losing ♠ on the good ♥8.

South is to play 7♣. West leads the ♦Q.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=0 ♣=0 Total = 1

It should be very clear that the only way to get rid of that ♠ loser is to discard it on dummy's ♥ suit. So after taking the first trick with dummy's ♦A you could pull trumps, then play ♥A, ♥K and ruff a ♥. **IF** the ♥s split 3-3 you could then enter dummy with the ♦K and discard your loser.

The problem is that the ♥s are much more likely to split 4-2, in which case you will need to ruff twice to establish a winner. That means you will need an extra entry to dummy.

That extra entry can only be the ♣10 so you must delay pulling trumps until after you ruff the first ♥. Win the ♦A and immediately play ♥A, ♥K and ruff a ♥ with a high ♣. West discards on this ♥ play. Enter dummy with a trump and ruff another ♥ high.

It may have seemed too risky to play ♥s before pulling trumps. In fact, there was no risk at all. If the ♥s were splitting 5-1 then you had absolutely no chance of making the contract.

And if they had split 3-3 this Plan would still have worked.